"Cuba will continue to suffer economic stagnation and an increasing rate of unemployment … [The agrarian reform] is in the best interests of the Cuban nation, which interest [the government] places above any others." He urged U.S. investors to support Cuba's plans for economic development by investing in industry, which the Cuban government was promoting as a route to national development, and the government to "induce United States investors affected by the Agrarian reform to help further the over-all development of the Cuban economy in accordance with the planned policy that is being carried out. The purpose of this creative policy, the cornerstone of which is Agrarian reform, is to increase productivity, encourage investments, raise the standard of living, and eliminate unemployment, which fully ensures the supplying of Cuban products to American consumers."[14]

Washington was not convinced. After a meeting with several large U.S. landholders on June 24th, the U.S. Secretary of State cabled the ambassador that "you should make every effort persuade GOC [Government of Cuba] avoid precipitate action in carrying out Agrarian Reform Law in its application American properties."[15] Another official concluded bluntly: "With the signature of the Agrarian Reform Law, it seems clear that our original hope was a vain one; Castro's Government is not the kind worth saving."[16]

The Ambassador could not deny that the Cuban population was overwhelmingly supportive of the new government and its reforms. The only opposition came from close supporters of Batista and members of his military, and property-holders whose properties were threatened. In his painstaking search for Communist influence in the new government, he came up empty-handed. Anti-Communists dominated the military, police, and security agencies. There was "no basis" for any of the rumors of Soviet or Chinese advisors. The worst he could say was that Castro's government had a "benevolent tolerance" for Cuba's Communist Party and "has not concentrated on this subject to extent desirable."[17] He elaborated:

> Castro has taken no interest in international situation or in threat of international Communism… I tried to explain significance of support